Template for an ARGUMENTATIVE essay

TITLE

Introduction (brief but clear overview of text)

- ✓ **Hook** – attention grabbing sentence (e.g. fact, statement, statistics, question)
- ✓ **Transition** to Thesis Statement (general to specific, let reader know what to expect)
- ✓ **Thesis Statement** (clearly state the purpose of the text)
- ✓ **Arguments** of text (usually 2 for and 1 against, no need to mention the rebuttal)

Body Paragraph 1 (start with strongest pro argument)

- ✓ **P oint** – Topic Sentence (should explain the focus of the paragraph, not too long)
- ✓ **E xplanation** – further elaborate on your point
- ✓ **E xample/evidence** – concreticise and illustrate with examples
- ✓ **L ink** – summarise, reiterate why this paragraph was important, transition

(Note: Remember to **signpost** by using **linkers** = easier to follow text, often in P + L)

Body Paragraph 2 (second pro argument)

- ✓ **P oint** – Topic Sentence (should explain the focus of the paragraph)
- ✓ **E xplanation** – further elaborate on your point
- ✓ **E xample/evidence** – concreticise and illustrate with examples
- ✓ **L ink** – summarise, reiterate why this paragraph was important, transition

Body Paragraph 3 (con argument + rebuttal)

- ✓ **P oint** – Topic Sentence with signpost (e.g. “However/In contrast/On the other hand”)
- ✓ **E xplanation** – further elaborate on your point
- ✓ **E xample/evidence** – concreticise and illustrate with examples
- ✓ **R ebuttal** – refute the counter and signpost (e.g. “However/Although/Despite this”)
- ✓ **E xplanation** – further elaborate on your point
- ✓ **E xample/evidence** – concreticise and illustrate with examples
- ✓ **L ink** – summarise, reiterate why this paragraph was important, transition

Conclusion (summarise and present take away)

- ✓ **R eiterate** – Summarise three points, start with con + rebuttal, signpost (e.g. “In conclusion”)
- ✓ **T ake away –** Paraphrase your thesis statement (message of your text)
- ✓ **C all to action –** Leave the recipient with a final thought or encourage action